
Introduction

What different roles and tasks exist in a transdisciplinary team? And what about you—how can you participate and contribute to the project?

Check this page now, but especially while you're working on the project.

The **theory page** discusses three core tasks: **acting**, **deciding**, and **facilitating**—tasks that naturally overlap.

Under the **practice tab**, you'll find a tool that helps you identify and compare these different roles and tasks.

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Theory

What mindsets, roles, and tasks exist in a transdisciplinary team? And what about you—how can you participate and contribute to the project? We distinguish several tasks and associated roles in a transdisciplinary project. These include:

- **Acting**
- **Deciding**
- **Facilitating**

Different roles can—and likely will—overlap.

Acting

The core task of “acting” in a process involves your own contributions, regardless of your role or stakeholder position. Don’t hesitate to take responsibility, step outside your comfort zone, and encourage others to do the same. Remember: you’re in this together. Another shared attitude that is intrinsic to transdisciplinarity is a **curious mindset**. Since nothing is clear at the start of a transdisciplinary project, you must be willing to explore and generate new knowledge.

Decision-Making

Decisions in the project are made by various actors—not just those with the most experience or the loudest voice. In the safe environment of a transdisciplinary project, **everyone must be heard**.

Facilitating

At times, one individual must oversee the entire process, stimulate breakthroughs, and balance group needs with practical constraints. We call these individuals **guides**. Guides have two distinct roles in transdisciplinary projects:

First, they set up and co-design the TRAIL, and later they foster the processes as **coaches**. This applies especially—but not exclusively—to educational settings, where teachers or fellow students can guide the learning process of participating students.

Regardless of the role you take on during the project, you also enter the process from a specific **stakeholder position**. Your prior experience from this position will almost certainly influence how you experience a transdisciplinary process.

That's why the following subpages discuss the roles and tasks for each stakeholder, including typical changes in habits compared to disciplinary professional or educational realities.

Practice

This page is still under development. Tools related to this topic will follow soon.

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